

Chapter 40-2

The first line was Liang Shi's.

Liang Shi closed her eyes, and when she opened them again, she had adjusted her state. As soon as she spoke, she was completely different from before—with clear and resonant broadcasting diction¹, rich emotion, and very appropriate facial expressions, though one could tell she was slightly nervous.

She spoke three lines before it was Chen Liuying's turn.

Chen Liuying directly adopted an aggressive acting approach, grabbing Liang Shi's collar right from the start with a fierce and menacing appearance that frightened quite a few people, and also slightly startled Liang Shi.

But in just a moment, Liang Shi came back to her senses and confronted her.

...

This scene quickly ended.

Chen Liuying had adopted an unexpected but reasonable acting method. Her bold and dramatic emotions made everyone present feel her anger and despair.

It should be a performance worthy of 7 points.

Even Liang Shi, who was her opponent, felt that her improvement was significant, much better than when she performed in the crew some time ago.

Perhaps some people were naturally suited for villain roles.

After Chen Liuying finished performing, seeing the flash of amazement in the director's eyes, she was triumphant and confident as she looked at Liang Shi with some provocation.

Liang Shi ignored her provocation. Having gotten too deeply into the female lead's character just now, she was having trouble getting out of character. She was quickly adjusting her state to help herself exit the role.

It was also at this time that she understood Chen Liuying's intention.

Supporting someone else's performance didn't require being too emotionally invested, so it could be placed later.

Her powerful explosive performance earlier could create psychological pressure on her opponent. Under her strong impact, any actor who understood acting would be involuntarily drawn into character, and then getting out of character to perform the part they were auditioning for would definitely compromise their state significantly.

Who knows who gave Chen Liuying this advice.

It could be said that her wishful thinking was crackling away, calculating both psychological and physical aspects.

Liang Shi was desperately taking deep breaths at the side of the stage, while the director below was already urging, "Miss Liang, are you ready? Time is limited, just say something when you're ready."

Liang Shi gestured an OK sign toward the audience below.

Then she walked back to center stage, looking like she wasn't in good condition, even appearing somewhat frail.

She didn't look at all like someone who could play a villain.

Chen Liuying, who was supporting her performance, held the script and continued to read lines in the same manner as before, making it easy for people to be misled into character.

All psychological tactics.

Liang Shi couldn't help but laugh.

It had been a long time since she'd seen such boring tactics.

After Chen Liuying finished reading her lines, it perfectly connected with Liang Shi's disdainful laugh.

The smile spread from the corner of her mouth to her eyes. Those bright eyes stared straight at Chen Liuying, then she shrugged contemptuously: "Winners and losers need no further words."

The tone in which she delivered this line was completely different from before.

Dejected, low-spirited, with a touch of disdain.

She completely interpreted the deep meaning of this line.

Her clear and resonant broadcasting diction carried a hint of sobbing, yet still maintained the pride of a wealthy young lady.

Just this one line made everyone below gasp in amazement.

This... this was the character herself!

Walking out from the drama.

Zhao Ying watched the reactions of the director and Yang Shuyan with interest.

The director's eyes were now bright, as if he had found gold.

Yang Shuyan nodded slightly, acknowledging Liang Shi's acting skills.

The performance on stage continued. Liang Shi became increasingly calm and composed, her eyes reddening, but it didn't affect her delivery of lines at all.

When she smiled and then sang that line "Life is naturally full of endless regret like flowing water to the east"² in a melodious operatic voice, the director was already so excited he wanted to slam the table, but was held down by Zhao Ying at the crucial moment.

The director's eyes widened as he excitedly mouthed: "Yes, yes, yes! Exactly!"

Only she understood this line!

Only she sang it!

And it was melancholy and lingering, with countless turns and twists, sung so heartbreakingly!

Zhao Ying smiled with satisfaction, as if saying—how could the person I recommended be wrong?

...

When Liang Shi finished performing, she collapsed exhaustedly on the stage.

She closed her eyes, as if her life had also ended along with the character.

There was a brief silence in the venue.

Everyone held their breath, afraid of disturbing the person who was sleeping on stage.

There was reluctance about her departure, sadness, and even Omegas with low tear thresholds were already teary-eyed.

A few seconds later, it was the director who first stood up and applauded with red-rimmed eyes.

Then thunderous applause followed.

Footnotes:

¹ **Broadcasting diction:** Refers to the clear, precise pronunciation and speech patterns used by professional radio and television announcers in China, characterized by perfect articulation and proper tone.

² **"Life is naturally full of endless regret like flowing water to the east":** This is a reference to a famous line from classical Chinese poetry, specifically from Li Yu's (李煜) poem "Waves Washing Sand" (浪淘沙). The original line is "自是人生長恨水長東" and expresses the sentiment that life is inherently filled with endless sorrow and regret, like water that flows continuously eastward. It's often used to convey deep melancholy and the inevitability of loss and disappointment in life.